

Profile

Personal Information

Name PARIT, JACKSON TUPANA
Preferred Name PJ
Sex, Birthdate Male, 11/03/1999

Contact Details

Email, Phone jackparit002@gmail.com, +254.797067901, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent Address P.O. Box 1017 Narok, Rift Valley, 20500, KEN

Demographics

Military Status None
Hispanic or Latino No
Race Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English Speak, Read, Write
Swahili Speak, Read, Write
Other, Maa First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Narok, Kenya (0 Years US, 18 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa None
Intended US Visa F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested

Yes, Signed: J Parit

My annual family income falls within the Income Eligibility Guidelines set by the USDA Food and Nutrition Service

I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader

Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Mr. OLOLOISUNGA TUPANA
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	+254.723660812, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	Other, LIVESTOCK FARMER, Self-Employed
Education	None

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. NARAMAT TUPANA
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	+254.706841918, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	Other, Casual labourer, Self-Employed
Education	None

Siblings

1. SILVIA N TUPANA, Age 24, Sister, Graduated from college/university, Bachelors, (09/2012 - 04/2016),
KENYATTA UNIVERSITY, Nairobi, KEN
2. JENNIFER S KISOTU, Age 22, Sister, Graduated from college/university, Bachelors, (09/2012 - 04/2016),
KENYATTA UNIVERSITY, NAIROBI, KEN
3. EVERLINE N TUPANA, Age 20, Sister, Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)
4. DANSON K KISOTU, Age 15, Brother, Some high/secondary school
5. GLADYS K KISOTU, Age 13, Sister, Some grade/primary school

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

ALLIANCE HIGH SCHOOL, P.O BOX 7-00902 KIKUYU, Nairobi, KEN, Public (02/2013 - 11/2016)

Counselor Ms. Gladys N Otido, Careers Counselor
Email, Phone gnanzala2010@gmail.com, +254.722354971
Boarding School Yes: Not Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2016

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 15 / 399, Unweighted
GPA 3.8 / 4, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
English	English	English
Swahili	Swahili	Swahili
Mathematics	Mathematics	Mathematics
Geography	Geography	Geography
Economics and Commerce	Economics and Commerce	Economics and Commerce
Physics	Physics	Physics
Biology	Biology	Biology
Chemistry	Chemistry	Chemistry

Honors

Best in school, National Mathematics Olympiad	School, State/Regional	12
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Position 3, Carey Francis Memorial Mathematics Contest	National	12
Best in form, Chemistry, end-of-year exams	School	10, 11
Position 2 in form, overall, end-of-year exams	School	9

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	Kenya Scholar-Athlete Project (KenSAP)
Counselor	Mr. John Manners
Email, Phone	jhmanners@gmail.com, +1.973-783-1592

Future Plans

Undecided, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	680	10/07/2017
Math	750	10/07/2017
Essay	14	10/07/2017
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Chemistry	11/2017
Math Level 1	11/2017
Physics	11/2017

Leaving Exams

English	B	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	A-	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Mathematics	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Biology	A-	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Geography	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Business Studies	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Internship

PG	Relationship Cash Officer, Equity Bank
Year	Offered position as paid intern based on KCSE results. Worked as a teller at local branch serving up to 250 customers per day.
60 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	

Student Govt./Politics

12	Dorm Captain and House Vice Captain.
School	One of 35 Senior Captains with significant duties. In charge of dorm order & cleanliness; with house captain, organized house activities.
15 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	

Student Govt./Politics

11	Activities Coordinator, House Committee
School	Organized and supervised house activities such as music, drama and sports competitions.
14 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	

Science/Math

12	Committee Member, Math Club
School	Charged with supervising and setting content for inter-house and inter-class math competitions, plus preparation for inter-school contests.
4 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	

Athletics: Club

11, 12	Cross-country, Manager & Competitor, House Cross-Country Team
School	
5 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr	Led house to annual inter-house cross country championship, 2015; won individual competition, 2015.

Community Service (Volunteer)

PG	Volunteer teacher
Year	Taught chemistry and physics at St. Anthony's Secondary School.
4 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12, PG

Break

2 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr

Continue

Founder, Star Students Association

Founded a high school student association to help students improve academic performance and leadership skills during school holidays.

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12

School, Break

2 hr/wk, 50 wk/yr

Continue

Member, Community Service Society

As club member, visited elderly and children's homes on weekends. Taught at Hidden Talents Academy for Orphans.

Environmental

10, 11, 12, PG

School

3 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr

Continue

Member, Interact Club

A subsidiary of Rotary International, the club engaged in environmental conservation in school and surrounding community.

Writing

Personal Essay

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.

A Maasai Boyhood

The late afternoon sky was light grey. Downpours minutes earlier had left my coat drenched, and the cold made my fingers uncooperative. The sheep and goats were running around, probably to rid their fur of moisture or warm their bodies. The long rains had just begun, a season any herdsman abhors. It brought out the love-hate relationship between the Maasai and nature

I was born into the pastoralist community of the Maasai in southern Kenya, whose life revolved around livestock. As soon as a boy can walk, he accompanies his older brothers to the grazing fields. At six he is armed with light wooden weapons to guide livestock—young goats and lambs, herded separately from the larger animals. I spent most childhood days looking after a flock of about twenty lambs, aided by my brother two years younger.

At ten, boys join the young men in caring for larger herds. This is the most trying stage for any Maasai boy. Herding a flock of more than a hundred sheep is no easy job, even in the expansive plains. Some animals stray, and unlike the Biblical shepherd, you cannot afford to leave the ninety nine to look for the one. Yet if you should lose an animal, you would suffer a serious thrashing. You have to count the sheep every two hours, a task made more difficult during the heavy rains. It was forbidden to drive the herd home before sundown, so you had to endure the daily drenching.

I was luckier than some of my pals when a teacher proposed to my father that I be enrolled in school as I was likely to do well. How he arrived at that conclusion still baffles me, but he was right. My father was against it, insisting that as his eldest son I should stay as close to his herd as possible. Contrary to common belief, it was far easier for a Maasai girl to be enrolled in school than a boy, at least at the primary level. What ultimately changed his mind was my small size. Eventually, my father agreed that the classroom may suit me better. It seemed an escape from the daily adversity of the plains but I would soon find out what it meant to be in school.

In any case, during holidays I was back on the plains with the animals. During the dry December holidays, we had to move the livestock to distant wetter areas, trekking as far as 300 kilometers in two weeks. In these circumstances, the real challenge lay in protecting the livestock from predators. In December 2012, my male relatives and I herded about 300 sheep and goats to the lower Suswa plains, 250 kilometers from home. We moved slowly through the uninhabited plains as the flock grazed. At sunset, we constructed temporary shelters for the herd and herders. At night, we alternated sleep with watching the sheep. Hyenas, lions and elusive leopards lurked in the darkness. You have to know when to expect an attack and when to lose a few animals for the sake of your life. It paid to know the features of each beast and how it would react in an attack. Fortunately, we had few encounters and only lost a few animals.

The carnivores were not the only challenge. The hot plains favored various snakes, some of which were large enough swallow a goat whole. One species I never came across is said to trick its prey by bleating like a goat. More dangerous to humans was the black mamba, whose venom was almost always lethal. I never met any of these, either, but they were alive in my imagination—another challenge in the struggle to protect the herd and, at times, myself. I cherish many memories of this time in my life, but I have no wish to relive them.

Additional Information

In my Personal Essay, I mentioned that enrolling in school enabled me to leave behind the herding life of my childhood. At first I looked forward to escaping the daily hardships, but I found that school brought challenges of its own.

As the local teacher had predicted to my father, I did well at school. At first my chief goal was to avoid the cane, so I ran to school to be on time and generally remained alert to keep from annoying the teachers. As years passed and I succeeded on exams, I was advised to transfer to a better school in far off Narok. The school had no proper dormitory, so boarders stayed in a children's home run by a Canadian foundation. It is was there in Narok that I first became aware of the wider world.

The boarding arrangements were a challenge, with little food and demanding duties. At the end of class at 4 PM, we boarders were required to collect firewood and attend to cleaning duties. Our weekends were taken up with tilling, weeding and watering the small farm attached to the children's home. The home's gate was locked except to let us out for school in the morning and back in the evening. Our few free minutes were spent playing soccer on a grassless yard. The routine was so monotonous that I yearned to be back on the plains, with all the hardships and risks.

My escape was reading—novels, textbooks, old newspapers, whatever I could find. Without knowing it, I encountered real literature: *Frankenstein*, *Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea*, *Robinson Crusoe*, *Wuthering Heights*. Reading relieved my despair and fostered some grand ambitions.

I sat the national primary school exam in December, 2012, and my result earned me a place at Alliance High School, widely considered Kenya's best. Before joining high school, I went home. While I had been away, a severe drought had killed hundreds of livestock and many crops, leading to a serious famine. The diminished herds meant I was relieved of my herding duties, but high stress caused conflicts at home. My mother was beaten repeatedly. This was not new, nor was it unique to my family, but it was a relief to leave again to join high school.

Alliance's fees were entirely beyond my family's reach, but I had been granted a Wings to Fly Scholarship from Equity Bank. I was determined to pursue my grand ambitions, and I managed to rank consistently in the top five percent. Meanwhile, the situation at home was deteriorating. My father had become quite violent towards me. Minor matters became capital offences, and on one occasion I was forced to flee back to school without my school bag and books.

Holidays became nightmares, and I usually chose to stay at school, doing chores to pay for my upkeep. Staying away from home gave me time to read and think without distractions. When I sat my national exams, I didn't achieve the perfect score I had dreamt of, but I was proud to have done well. I was awarded a paid internship at Equity Bank starting in January 2017, which went a long way in easing my parents' financial burden.

Today I can look back in comfort on the rainy days I endured as a herd boy, the hardships of the children's home and the daily domestic violence in my own home. I've survived them all, and I'm more eager than ever to pursue my grand ambitions.

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

Kenyan high school graduates who qualify for university admission must wait ten months before enrolling. Upon graduating in November 2016, I spent December at home taking care of my father's cows and tending the family farm. In the afternoons I assisted local high school students with their schoolwork, teaching chemistry, physics and mathematics.

In January, when results of the national high school exams were released, my score earned me an offer of an internship at Equity Bank. After two weeks of training, I worked at the Narok branch as a teller. The job was quite engaging, I served up to 250 customers daily working for up to eleven hours, from seven in the morning to six in the evening. On Saturday afternoons, after leaving the bank, I taught chemistry and physics at St. Anthony's Secondary School in Narok town. I worked at Equity for six months and left in June.

In July I was chosen to join KenSAP, a highly-selective program that helps outstanding Kenyan high school graduates from needy backgrounds apply to American colleges. The program's residential sessions lasted fourteen weeks and were spent preparing for the SAT and SAT Subject Tests, learning about the American university system and working on applications. While at the program, I also tutored pupils at the local primary school, preparing them for the coming national exams. I also was instructed in taekwondo and earned a yellow belt. After KenSAP, I will go back to Equity Bank until the time comes to enter university.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Have you ever been adjudicated guilty or convicted of a misdemeanor or felony?

No

Cornell University Questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2018
Admission plan	Early Decision
ROTC Participation Interest	No
Early Decision Agreement	Yes, I have read and understand my rights and responsibilities under the Early Decision Process. I wish to be considered as an Early Decision candidate at Cornell University. I also understand that with an Early Decision offer of admissions, this institution may share my name and my early commitment with other institutions. J Parit
Previous Candidate	No

Academics

College or School to which you are applying (choose only one):	Arts and Sciences
Anticipated major within the college/school you've chosen (select only one):	Chemistry and Chemical Biology

Applicants to the College of Agriculture and Life Sciences, College of Arts and Sciences, the School of Hotel Administration in the SC Johnson College of Business, and College of Human Ecology may be considered for January 2019 admission. Learn more about the First-Year Spring Admission program online at: admissions.cornell.edu/fysa. In addition to being considered for Fall 2018, I am interested in First Year Spring Admission in January 2019.

No

Contacts

Previously applied

No

If you wish to be contacted via mobile phone, please provide your phone number. Contact methods may include phone calls generated from an automated telephone dialing system or text messaging.

I consent to be contacted by Cornell University at the mobile phone number provided below.

Mobile Phone Number:

+254.797067901

Family

Sibling applied	No
Relatives attended member	No
Relative employed at member	No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.